COMP3851A – Computing and Information Sciences WIL

School of Computer and Information Sciences

University of Newcastle – 2026

INTERIM REPORT

The interim report should be an extension of the project plan. The length of the document must be 2,500 words, with a 10% tolerance up or down. References and title page do not contribute to the word count.

There are two sections to the group report:

- Group section: 2,500 words
- Individual section: 1,000 words

There is no limit for the number of tables and figures. In the title page, the report must include title, student(s) name(s), supervisor name and industry/research group where the project was undertaken. Please feel free to modify the template for the project plan and re-use it for the interim report. The sections that must be included in the document are described next.

Obs: Note that if the deliverables related to the project (including any source code) are not provided to the company (or project supervisor) and/or not deployed to the client's infrastructure satisfactorily, the student might be given an "I" (Incomplete) grade until those steps are completed.

GROUP PROJECTS

GROUP SECTION

1. **Project title:** no more than 20 words

2. **Background** (1,000 words)

   - What is the background of the company/institution?
   - What is the object of the work or problem to be solved?
   - What is the motivation for the project?
   - How is the problem addressed now by the company or the professional community?
   - Is the project genuinely feasible in the timeframe available (240 hours)?
   - Are the team's skills adequate?

3. **Aims** (250 words)

   - Adjust the aims from the project plan as needed.
   - Keep aims clear and succinct. Use a numbered list for easier cross-reference.
   - Indicate which aims have already been completed, ongoing and not started.
   - Aims must be attached to deliverables or functional requirements. Use between one and two sentences to provide more context for each aim.
   - Self-learning is NOT an aim – it belongs to the "Methods and activities" section.
   - Using a programming language or framework is NOT an aim – it belongs to the methods/activities section. Similarly, using a programming language or framework is NOT an aim – it belongs to the methods/activities section.

4. **Methods and activities** (250 words)

   - Adjust the methods and activities from the project plan as needed.
   - What are the activities required for each aim to be achieved?
   - Describe the methods and/or technologies to be used.
   - Activities can include self-learning required to acquire skills necessary for the project.
   - Link each item described to one or more aims.
   - Remember this is a capstone course, so activities must align with a 3rd year level project and require knowledge at that level.

5. **Results** (750 words)

   - Describe and critically analyse the results obtained.
   - Indicate any limitations to the results so far.
   - Results must reference the aims and methods.

6. **Ethics considerations** (250 words)

- Ethics issues can include confidentiality, privacy and use of proprietary data, among others.
- Will your software interact with people? Or collect data from people? Then you should detail that in this section.
- Will the general public (including minors) have access to your software or be affected by it?
- How secure will the software be? Do you have a plan for cyber security?
- Are there any risks (personal injury, loss of income, etc) for someone using your software?
- Will your project reference any guideline or policy related to the topic (e.g. Privacy Act 1998, ISM, etc)?

7. **References** (references do not contribute to the word limit):

- Even if your project is not academic in nature, references are always required.
- Include a list of all references used in the document.
- Cite the reference in the main text.
- Journal papers, websites, white papers, online reports, etc, are all valid references.
- Use a standard for citing references, e.g. Harvard style or IEEE style (https://www.citethisforme.com/)

INDIVIDUAL SECTION

Individual contribution, self-learning and project management (1,000 words)

- Describe your individual contribution to the project **in detail**.
- **Focus primarily on the parts of the project that you were responsible for**, and then on those where you helped others. Indicate, to the best of your estimation, the percentage of your contribution to each result of the project. Make sure you refer to the elements listed in the results section. Any other roles, e.g. project manager, should be indicated in this section as well, with a description of the responsibilities in those roles.
- Describe all self-directed learning necessary to achieve the results described above and any additional self-learning that you will engage in Part B.
- Discuss how project management tools contributed to the results and the timely completion of the activities.
- How frequent were the meetings with your supervisor and with your colleagues? How was your attendance at those meetings? Did you participate with ideas and thoughts, or did you remain mostly quiet and listening to others?
- How were your interactions with your team members? Did you deliver your tasks on time and at a high-quality level? Or did you deliver your parts of the project, say, the day before the due date, leaving no time for corrections?

Please take the time to proof-read your submission and be attentive to details, e.g. placement of figures and tables, typos, correct referencing, and make the text flows well by connecting the various parts of the report.

The use of Generative AI is not allowed in the writing of this assessment.